A N T H R O P I C

Claude AI Generalist

Complete Learning Journey

From Zero to Proficient — 8-Week Roadmap

anthropic.skilljar.com

Document	Details
Purpose	Step-by-step guide for mastering Claude AI from beginner to expert
Audience	Professionals, developers, students, and AI enthusiasts
Duration	8 Weeks structured learning path
Courses	12 official Anthropic Academy courses
Platform	anthropic.skilljar.com
Version	2025 Edition
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Powered by Anthropic Academy • Claude AI • Official Curriculum

1. Program Overview

Welcome to your official Claude AI Generalist Learning Journey — a structured, 8-week curriculum built on Anthropic's official Academy courses. This document serves as your complete roadmap, from your first interaction with Claude to building production-grade AI-powered systems.

By the end of this journey, you will be able to use Claude confidently across everyday tasks, design advanced prompts, work with the Claude API, understand Model Context Protocol (MCP), and build agentic AI workflows.

1.1 Learning Objectives

- Understand Claude's capabilities, limitations, and how it thinks
- Master prompt engineering techniques for consistent, high-quality outputs
- Apply Claude across writing, coding, research, data, and creative work
- Build applications and agents using the Claude API
- Connect Claude to external systems via Model Context Protocol (MCP)
- Use Claude Code for developer-focused agentic workflows
- Practice responsible and ethical AI use in professional contexts

1.2 Program at a Glance

Category	Details
Total Courses	12 Official Anthropic Academy Courses
Duration	8 Weeks (recommended pace)
Phases	5 Progressive Learning Phases
Platform	anthropic.skilljar.com
Prerequisites	No prior AI or coding experience required for Phase 1-2
Certification	Completion certificates available per course on Skilljar
Support	education-support@anthropic.com

2. Your 8-Week Learning Roadmap

The roadmap below sequences all 12 official Anthropic Academy courses into a progressive learning path. Each phase builds on the previous one, ensuring you develop solid foundations before advancing.

Week	Phase & Focus
Week 1	Phase 1 — Build Your Foundation: AI Fluency + Claude 101
Week 2	Phase 2 — Develop Professional Skills: Claude API Fundamentals
Week 3–4	Phase 3 — Platform & Deployment: AWS Bedrock or Google Vertex AI
Week 5–6	Phase 4 — Master Agentic AI: MCP Introduction + Advanced Topics
Week 7	Phase 4 cont'd — Claude Code in Action + Agent Skills
Week 8	Phase 5 — Capstone, Teaching & Community: Specialize + Complete

3. The Official Courses — Detailed Breakdown

PHASE 1 Build Your Foundation

Weeks 1 • No prerequisites • Start here

Phase 1 establishes the mindset, vocabulary, and core skills every Claude user needs. These two courses together give you a solid understanding of how to think about AI collaboration and how to use Claude confidently in daily work.

① AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations

anthropic.skilljar.com/ai-fluency-framework-foundations

Learn to collaborate with AI systems effectively, efficiently, ethically, and safely. This foundational course establishes the mental models you need before using any AI tool professionally. Covers AI collaboration principles, ethical use, and safety considerations.

What you'll learn:

- Core framework for working with AI systems effectively
- Ethical and safe AI collaboration principles
- How to evaluate AI outputs critically
- Vocabulary and mental models for AI literacy

Recommended for: Everyone — this is your mindset foundation.

②

Claude 101

anthropic.skilljar.com/claude-101

Learn how to use Claude for everyday work tasks, understand core features, and explore resources for more advanced learning. The essential primer for anyone starting with Claude — covers the interface, basic prompting, file uploads, and key features.

What you'll learn:

- Navigating Claude.ai interface (web, mobile, desktop)
- Uploading documents, images, and files for analysis
- Using Artifacts, web search, and code execution
- Core prompting techniques for everyday tasks
- Settings: memory, web search, style customization

Recommended for: All users — your essential 'how Claude works' primer.

PHASE 2 Develop Professional Skills

Week 2 • Requires Phase 1 completion

Phase 2 moves beyond the interface and into the Claude API — empowering you to build applications, automate workflows, and work programmatically with Claude models.

③

Building with the Claude API

anthropic.skilljar.com/claude-with-the-anthropic-api

A comprehensive course covering the full spectrum of working with Anthropic models using the Claude API. Learn authentication, prompt construction, conversation management, tool use, streaming, and best practices for production API usage.

What you'll learn:

- API authentication, endpoints, and rate limits
- Using claude-sonnet-4-6, claude-haiku-4-5, and claude-opus-4-6 models
- Streaming responses and managing conversation history
- Tool use and function calling via the API
- Building multi-turn conversations programmatically
- Best practices for production API integration

Prerequisites: Basic Python or JavaScript knowledge helpful but not required.

PHASE 3 Platform & Cloud Deployment

Weeks 3-4 • Choose your cloud provider

Phase 3 covers deploying Claude in enterprise cloud environments. Choose the track that matches your infrastructure — AWS Bedrock or Google Cloud Vertex AI. Both courses cover the same Claude capabilities through their respective platforms.

4

Claude with Amazon Bedrock

anthropic.skilljar.com/claude-in-amazon-bedrock

A first-of-its-kind training created for AWS, covering the full spectrum of deploying and working with Claude on Amazon Bedrock. Covers API integration, model configuration, security, and AWS-specific patterns for production Claude deployments.

What you'll learn:

- Accessing Claude models through Amazon Bedrock
- AWS IAM authentication and permission configuration
- Bedrock-specific API patterns and best practices
- Cost management, monitoring, and scaling on AWS
- Integration with other AWS services

Choose this track if: Your organization uses AWS infrastructure.

5

Claude with Google Cloud's Vertex AI

anthropic.skilljar.com/claude-with-google-vertex

A comprehensive course covering the full spectrum of working with Anthropic models through Google Cloud's Vertex AI. Covers Vertex AI configuration, Claude model access, GCP authentication, and Google Cloud-specific deployment patterns.

What you'll learn:

- Accessing Claude through Google Cloud's Vertex AI platform
- GCP authentication, service accounts, and IAM
- Vertex AI-specific API patterns and configurations
- Integration with Google Cloud services and tools
- Scaling and monitoring Claude deployments on GCP

Choose this track if: Your organization uses Google Cloud Platform.

PHASE 4 Master Agentic AI & MCP

Weeks 5-7 • Advanced development skills

Phase 4 is where you become a true Claude power user and builder. You'll master Model Context Protocol (MCP) to connect Claude to external systems, Claude Code for development workflows, and Agent Skills for reusable automation.

⑥

Introduction to Model Context Protocol

anthropic.skilljar.com/introduction-to-model-context-protocol

Learn to build MCP servers and clients from scratch using Python. Master MCP's three core primitives — tools, resources, and prompts — to connect Claude with external services, databases, and APIs. The gateway to true AI-powered automation.

What you'll learn:

- MCP architecture and how it extends Claude's capabilities
- Building MCP servers in Python from scratch
- Implementing tools, resources, and prompt primitives
- Connecting Claude to external APIs and services
- Testing and debugging MCP implementations

⑦

Model Context Protocol: Advanced Topics

anthropic.skilljar.com/model-context-protocol-advanced-topics

Discover advanced MCP implementation patterns including sampling, notifications, file system access, and transport mechanisms for production MCP server development. Takes your MCP skills from working to production-grade.

What you'll learn:

- Advanced sampling and notification patterns
- File system access via MCP
- Production transport mechanisms (stdio, SSE, HTTP)
- Security best practices for MCP servers
- Scaling and deploying MCP servers in production

⑧

Claude Code in Action

anthropic.skilljar.com/claude-code-in-action

Integrate Claude Code into your real development workflow. This hands-on course teaches you to use Claude Code CLI for agentic coding — automated code generation, refactoring, testing, and documentation within your existing development environment.

What you'll learn:

- Installing and configuring Claude Code CLI
- Using Claude Code for code generation and refactoring
- Automated testing and debugging with Claude Code
- Integrating Claude Code into CI/CD pipelines
- Best practices for developer-focused AI workflows

⑨

Introduction to Agent Skills

anthropic.skilljar.com/introduction-to-agent-skills

Learn how to build, configure, and share Skills in Claude Code — reusable markdown instructions that Claude automatically applies to the right tasks at the right time. From creating your first Skill to distributing them across teams.

What you'll learn:

- Designing and writing effective Agent Skills in markdown
- Configuring Skills for automatic context detection
- Sharing Skills across teams and organizations
- Troubleshooting common Skill configuration issues
- Building a personal and team Skills library

PHASE 5 Teach, Lead & Specialize

Week 8 • For educators, leaders & domain specialists

Phase 5 is for those who want to go beyond personal proficiency and help others adopt AI effectively — whether in academic settings, nonprofit organizations, or broader institutional contexts.

⑩

AI Fluency for Educators

anthropic.skilljar.com/ai-fluency-for-educators

Empowers faculty, instructional designers, and educational leaders to apply AI Fluency in their own teaching practice and institutional strategy. Learn how to integrate Claude into curriculum design and student assessment.

⑪

Teaching AI Fluency

anthropic.skilljar.com/teaching-ai-fluency

Empowers academic faculty, instructional designers, and others to teach and assess AI Fluency in instructor-led settings. Covers pedagogy, assessment design, and facilitating hands-on AI learning experiences.

⑫

AI Fluency for Nonprofits

anthropic.skilljar.com/ai-fluency-for-nonprofits

Empowers nonprofit professionals to develop AI fluency to increase organizational impact and efficiency while staying true to mission and values. Covers ethical AI use, volunteer coordination, and impact measurement.

4. Your Mission Checklist

Use this checklist to track your progress through the full Claude AI Generalist journey. Check off each course as you complete it.

○	Phase 1 — Course ①: AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations
○	Phase 1 — Course ②: Claude 101
○	Phase 2 — Course ③: Building with the Claude API
○	Phase 3 — Course ④: Claude with Amazon Bedrock OR ⑤: Claude with Google Vertex AI
○	Phase 4 — Course ⑥: Introduction to Model Context Protocol
○	Phase 4 — Course ⑦: Model Context Protocol: Advanced Topics
○	Phase 4 — Course ⑧: Claude Code in Action
○	Phase 4 — Course ⑨: Introduction to Agent Skills
○	Phase 5 — Course ⑩⑪⑫: Teaching, Educators, or Nonprofits (as applicable)
○	Capstone: Build a real-world project using Claude that solves a genuine problem
○	Portfolio: Document your top 10 prompts and use cases in a personal prompt library

5. Suggested Weekly Schedule

Each week is designed to be completed in approximately 5–8 hours, including course work, practice exercises, and project time. Adjust based on your pace.

Week	Tasks & Milestones
Week 1	Complete AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations + Claude 101. Practice Task: Run 5 different Claude conversations (writing, coding, math, research, creative).
Week 2	Complete Building with the Claude API. Practice Task: Build a simple Python/JS script that calls the Claude API and has a multi-turn conversation.

Week 3	Complete Claude with Amazon Bedrock OR Claude with Google Vertex AI. Practice Task: Deploy a Claude-powered function on your chosen cloud platform.
Week 4	Review and consolidate Weeks 1-3. Build a mini-project: a Claude-powered tool for your daily workflow.
Week 5	Complete Introduction to Model Context Protocol. Practice Task: Build your first MCP server that exposes a simple tool to Claude.
Week 6	Complete MCP: Advanced Topics. Practice Task: Build a production-ready MCP server with file system access and proper error handling.
Week 7	Complete Claude Code in Action + Introduction to Agent Skills. Practice Task: Create 3 reusable Skills and share them with a colleague.
Week 8	Complete your chosen Phase 5 course. Finalize your Capstone project. Build your personal Prompt Library.

6. Tips for Success

6.1 Prompting Best Practices

- Always include Role + Task + Context + Format in your prompts
- Use few-shot examples (2-3 examples before your request) for consistent outputs
- Ask Claude to 'think step by step' for complex reasoning tasks
- Iterate: refine your prompt 3-5 times to get the best result
- Use XML tags (<context>, <task>, <format>) to organize complex inputs

6.2 Building Good Habits

- Keep a prompt journal — document what works and why
- Verify Claude's outputs on factual claims using web search
- Use thumbs up/down feedback to improve Claude's responses over time
- Start simple: 1 task per prompt, then build complexity
- Read Anthropic's Prompt Engineering docs at docs.claude.com regularly

6.3 Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Vague prompts: 'Help me with my project' — be specific about what you need
- Overloading: avoid asking 5 different things in one message
- Blind trust: always verify important facts, especially in code and research
- Skipping context: Claude can't read your mind — provide relevant background
- Ignoring iteration: the first response is rarely the best — refine and improve

7. Key Resources & Links

Resource	URL
Anthropic Academy (all courses)	anthropic.skilljar.com
Claude.ai (chat interface)	claude.ai
Anthropic Documentation	docs.claude.com
Prompt Engineering Guide	docs.claude.com/en/docs/build-with-claude/prompt-engineering/overview
Claude API Reference	docs.claude.com/en/api
MCP Documentation	docs.claude.com/en/docs/mcp
Anthropic Homepage	anthropic.com
Education Support Email	education-support@anthropic.com
Claude Support Center	support.claude.com

8. Capstone Project Ideas

Your capstone project should demonstrate real-world proficiency. Choose one of the ideas below or design your own — the goal is to build something genuinely useful that showcases your Claude AI skills.

Beginner Capstone

- Build a personal productivity assistant: a Claude-powered chatbot that helps you draft emails, summarize documents, and plan your week
- Create a research summarizer: upload any PDF and get a structured summary with key insights and action items
- Design a prompt library: curate 20+ prompts organized by use case with examples of excellent outputs

Intermediate Capstone

- Build an API-powered writing assistant: a web app that uses the Claude API to help users write and edit content with different tones
- Create a code reviewer: a tool that takes GitHub pull requests and generates detailed code review comments using Claude

- Develop a customer support bot: a multi-turn conversation agent that handles FAQs for a product or service

Advanced Capstone

- Build a full MCP server that connects Claude to a database, exposes CRUD operations as tools, and enables natural language data querying
- Create an agentic research assistant using Claude Code that automatically gathers, synthesizes, and reports on topics using multiple sources
- Design an enterprise Skills library: 10+ Claude Code Skills that automate development workflows for a software team

Your Journey Starts Now

Begin with Course ① — AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations

anthropic.skilljar.com

"The goal is not just to use AI — it's to collaborate with it skillfully."